

STATE OF NEW YORK

5781--B

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN SENATE

February 28, 2025

Introduced by Sens. HARCKHAM, ADDABBO, BAILEY, BRISPORT, BROUK, COONEY, GOUNARDES, HINCHEY, JACKSON, KAVANAGH, KRUEGER, LIU, MARTINS, MAY, MAYER, MYRIE, PALUMBO, RAMOS, ROLISON, C. RYAN, SALAZAR, SEPULVEDA, SERRANO, SKOUFIS, STAVISKY, WEBB -- read twice and ordered printed, and when printed to be committed to the Committee on Housing, Construction and Community Development -- reported favorably from said committee and committed to the Committee on Finance -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee -- recommitted to the Committee on Housing, Construction and Community Development in accordance with Senate Rule 6, sec. 8 -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the executive law, in relation to residential solar and energy storage permitting

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. Paragraphs i and j of subdivision 1 of section 381 of the
2 executive law, paragraph i as amended and paragraph j as added by
3 section 3 of part T of chapter 57 of the laws of 2023, are amended and a
4 new paragraph k is added to read as follows:

5 i. standards and procedures for measuring the rate of compliance with
6 the state energy conservation construction code, and provisions requir-
7 ing that such rate of compliance be measured on an annual basis; ~~and~~

8 j. procedures requiring the documentation of compliance with regu-
9 lations adopted pursuant to section thirteen hundred seventy-seven of
10 the public health law as a condition to issuance of a certificate of
11 occupancy or certificate of compliance following a periodic fire safety
12 and property maintenance inspection for multiple dwellings~~[-]; and~~

13 k. (i) standards and procedures requiring:

14 (A) any authority having jurisdiction over a population exceeding five
15 thousand residents to adopt a residential automated solar permitting

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets
[-] is old law to be omitted.

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platform by June thirtieth, two thousand twenty-seven, if such a platform without any initial fee or subscription fee to the authority having jurisdiction is available. The authority having jurisdiction shall anticipate that the residential automated solar permitting platform will have the capability to process at least seventy-five percent of residential solar applications for existing construction submitted to authorities having jurisdiction in the state.

(B) (1) authorities having jurisdiction to submit compliance reports to the department within sixty days of achieving compliance with clause (A) of this subparagraph, which shall include, but not be limited to:

(I) the date of compliance;

(II) the software or a combination of software used for compliance;

(III) confirmation that the authority having jurisdiction is using a residential automated solar permitting platform to instantly issue permits and permit revisions for residential solar photovoltaic systems; and

(IV) an explanation for why the authority having jurisdiction anticipates the residential automated solar permitting platform has the capability to process at least seventy-five percent of the residential solar photovoltaic permit applications on existing construction submitted to authorities having jurisdiction in the state. This explanation may be based on, but is not necessarily limited to, statements from the software provider of the residential automated solar permitting platform.

(2) The department may establish guidelines for the reports pursuant to item one of this clause.

(3) The department may determine the accuracy of the authority having jurisdiction's report of compliance pursuant to clause one of this subparagraph. The department may also make such findings publicly available and may take necessary actions to enforce compliance with clause (A) of this subparagraph based on such findings.

(C) (1) authorities having jurisdiction to submit annual reports to the department on the usage of the residential automated solar permitting platform. Between April first, two thousand twenty-eight and April first, two thousand thirty-seven, each authority having jurisdiction shall submit such reports annually by April first covering the previous calendar year. The department may establish guidelines for these reports. Such reports shall include the following:

(I) the number of permits issued through the residential automated solar permitting platform and relevant characteristics of those systems;

(II) the number of residential photovoltaic solar permits issued by means other than the residential automated solar permitting platform and relevant characteristics of those systems;

(III) the software or combination of software used for compliance;

(IV) confirmation that the authority having jurisdiction is using a residential automated solar permitting platform to issue permits instantly and issue permit revisions instantly for residential solar photovoltaic systems; and

(V) a plan to increase usage of the residential automated solar permitting platform if fewer than seventy-five percent of residential solar photovoltaic permits are issued through the automated permitting platform on existing construction.

(2) The department may determine the accuracy of the authority having jurisdiction's annual report pursuant to item one of this clause. The department may also make such findings publicly available and may take necessary actions to enforce compliance with clause (A) of this subparagraph based on such findings.

1 (D) authorities having jurisdiction over a population exceeding five
2 thousand residents to provide an option for remote inspections via
3 recorded video or photo that can be submitted electronically for
4 projects permitted by the residential automated solar permitting plat-
5 form. Such inspections shall be offered at no greater cost and with no
6 greater delay than in-person inspections.

7 (ii) An authority having jurisdiction that does not require a permit
8 for residential photovoltaic solar systems is exempt from the require-
9 ments of this paragraph.

10 (iii) As used in this paragraph, the following terms shall have the
11 following meanings:

12 (A) "Department" means the New York state energy research and develop-
13 ment authority.

14 (B) "Residential automated solar permitting platform" means software
15 or a combination of software designed to automate plan review, generate
16 code-compliant approvals, accept online payments for permitting fees, if
17 applicable, and instantly issue permits and permit revisions for resi-
18 dential photovoltaic systems upon online submission of a code-compliant
19 application and payment of any required fees. Such platform shall be
20 available for residential photovoltaic systems up to the maximum capaci-
21 ty allowed with a two hundred amp main service disconnect, installed in
22 accordance with the residential code of New York state, as updated, that
23 may also include an energy storage system up to the maximum capacity
24 allowed under the residential code of New York state, a main panel
25 upgrade, and/or a main breaker derate.

26 (C) "Authority having jurisdiction" shall refer to any city, town,
27 village, county, or other governmental unit or agency responsible for
28 the administration and enforcement of the uniform fire prevention and
29 building code and the state energy conservation construction code, as
30 defined in 19 NYCRR, section 1203.1, as updated.

31 § 2. This act shall take effect immediately.